



IT and Cybersecurity Governance Manual

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1. Governance Charter

1.1. Policy Statement

- 1.1.1. Pakistan Cables Ltd. (PCL or the Company) shall operate a centralized IT and cybersecurity governance framework aligned with NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF 2.0) and ISO/IEC 27001:2022.
- 1.1.2. This framework shall serve as the primary mechanism for **proactive risk identification and threat mitigation**.
- 1.1.3. All digital assets, systems, cloud platforms, AI tools, and technology services shall originate, operate, and be maintained under the IT governance authority. All technology initiatives must undergo a documented risk assessment and centralised procurement, as per IT Software and Hardware procurement policy.

2. Governance Structure

2.1. Chief Executive Officer (CEO)

- 2.1.1. The CEO is the executive owner of cyber risk.
- 2.1.2. The CEO shall:
 - Approve high-risk exceptions to technology governance policies.
 - Chair or oversee executive-level IT & cybersecurity governance reviews.

2.2. IT Steering Committee (ITSC)

- 2.2.1. The ITSC acts as the operational governance body for technology decisions.
- 2.2.2. Key responsibilities include:
 - Reviewing and approving major IT investments (includes CAPEX and OPEX both above 1.5 Million)
 - Evaluating technology risks and business alignment.
 - Ensuring technology standardization across departments.
 - Monitoring progress of IT and cybersecurity initiatives.
- 2.2.3. The ITSC shall meet periodically to review:
 - IT risk posture
 - Digital transformation initiatives
 - Technology architecture compliance
 - Vendor and technology risks

2.3. Business Heads

- 2.3.1. Business heads are owners of digital usage risk within their departments.



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- Providing advisory support to the ITSC and executive leadership.

3. Digital Acquisition Governance

3.1. All hardware, software, SaaS, AI platforms, and cloud services shall follow the Structured Digital Intake Process:

- Business justification submission via IT Service Desk.
- IT technical and cybersecurity assessment, including a third party risk assessment for vendors.
- Risk classification
- Approval reference issuance
- Procurement execution
- Asset / license registration
- Secure configuration & deployment

3.2. Procurement and Finance systems shall require IT approval/vetting references before PO issuance or payment release.

3.3. All digital/ technology acquisition requests must enter through IT Service Desk.

3.4. Following details shall be provided:

- Business justification
- Data classification
- Risk category
- Budget owner
- System integration impact

3.5. No digital acquisition, subscription, or technology deployment shall proceed without documented IT authorization.

4. Asset & Configuration Governance

4.1. PCL shall maintain:

- 4.1.1. Centralized Asset Register
- 4.1.2. Software & License Register
- 4.1.3. SaaS & Cloud Register
- 4.1.4. AI Tool Register
- 4.1.5. Vendor Risk Register

4.2. No system shall connect to the corporate network without:



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- 4.2.1. Asset registration
- 4.2.2. Security baseline configuration
- 4.2.3. Endpoint protection installation
- 4.2.4. Identity binding

5. Identity & Access Governance

5.1. All systems must:

- 5.1.1. Use corporate identity (SSO integration)
- 5.1.2. Enforce MFA (Multi-factor Authentication)
- 5.1.3. Apply least privilege
- 5.1.4. Undergo documented quarterly user access review (after 90 days) undertaken by IT Security team
- 5.1.5. Be automatically deprovisioned on exit

5.2. No personal email-based subscriptions permitted.

6. Data Protection & Cloud Governance

6.1. The Company shall ensure:

- 6.1.1. Encryption at rest and in transit
- 6.1.2. Data classification enforcement
- 6.1.3. Cloud vendor due diligence
- 6.1.4. Data residency evaluation
- 6.1.5. Exit and data deletion assurance

6.2. Upload of PCL data to external platforms without IT authorization is prohibited.

7. Monitoring & Detection

7.1. The Company shall implement:

- 7.1.1. Centralised logging
- 7.1.2. SaaS usage visibility
- 7.1.3. License compliance reviews
- 7.1.4. Vulnerability and patch management
- 7.1.5. Quarterly governance reporting to the CEO

8. Incident Response and Cyber Resilience



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8.1. The Company shall maintain a structured incident response capability.

8.2. The Company shall maintain a computer security incident reporting mechanism, led by the Head of IT, with oversight from the ITSC.

8.3. PCL shall maintain:

8.3.1. Incident classification matrix

8.3.2. Ransomware containment protocol

8.3.3. Executive notification procedure

8.3.4. Disaster recovery procedures (RTO/RPO defined)

8.4. The incident response lifecycle includes:

- Detection
- Containment
- Investigation
- Recovery
- Post-incident review
- No employee, including Business Heads, shall communicate with the media, customers, or regulators regarding a security incident without explicit authorisation from the CEO.
- The Head of IT must monitor the status of critical 3rd party providers and report outages to the affected Business Heads.

9. Risk Management & Exceptions

9.1. The Business Head requesting the exception must formally "Accept" the risk on behalf of their department.

9.2. Exceptions require:

- Every exception must be accompanied by a documented risk assessment with risk impact analysis conducted by IT, outlining the specific threats introduced by the deviation.
- Compensating controls
- CEO approval for high-risk deviations and ITSC's approval for Low & Medium risk deviations
- Inclusion in centralized risk register

APPROVED BY
CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER